

MANDAR DEODHAR



SHE'S GOTTA HAVE IT

Gota work on the borders of lehengas and anarkali kurtas. Creations by Manish Malhotra and Rohit Bal (below).



war kameezes are a hit among the to-be-hitched crowd. "Surprisingly, many have also been asking for gowns," says Kunjan Budhiraja, head merchandiser, multi-label Mumbai store Amara where bridal wear by Shyamal and Bhumika has caught the customer's fancy.

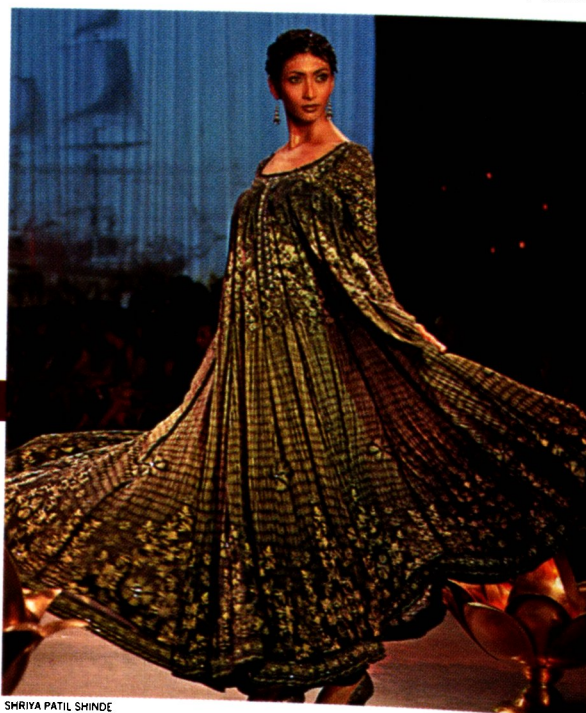
Customers are increasingly looking for western silhouettes for that extra edge. Alka Nishar, owner of Mumbai designer store Aza, says, "People are no longer blindly picking up stuff with zardozi." The result is that corsets, fishtail lehengas and brocade jackets have been moving off the racks. So if Manish Malhotra's crushed lehengas with gota work are a hit at Aza, Ritu Kumar says she's overwhelmed with the response her kalamkari motif jackets with leather quilting received at her show at the fashion extravaganza.

Classic wedding designers like Tarun Tahiliani, JJ Valaya, Rohit Bal and Sabyasachi Mukherjee are still sought after. It is not surprising then that Tahiliani, at a personal consultancy event at Mumbai store Ensemble, received over 40 orders based on his Couture Week showing of elaborate lehengas, saris and churidar kurtas. Of course, though the Couture Week was sold as a one of a kind luxury event starring the best of India's fashion fraternity, it ended up being a

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OLD IS GOLD

The angarkha or empire waist is still a hot favourite for the salwar kameez but it has shed some of its volume this season. Designs by Tarun Tahiliani (left) and Malhotra.



SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE



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